rate of fire, which combined with an acute shortage of ammunition, was crippling.

The Chinese on the other hand, when shooting downhill, found their fire plunging and were left with no choice but to close the gap with Hoshiar's men. Here, too, the Chinese were left grappling with individual defenders in close quarter battles that were dominated by bayonets, rifle butts and percussion grenades. Having run out of ammunition, Hoshiar had discarded his rifle and picked up a Sten. However, while kneeling down to change the magazine, he was struck a blinding blow from a grenade that lacerated his upper arms and chest. Thrown backwards, he was pinned down by four Chinese soldiers who realized he was the platoon commander from the binoculars and compass on him. Even then he fought ferociously, refusing to give up. Finally, bleeding profusely and panting from his exertions, he was subdued and taken prisoner. By then, approximately four hours after the first shells had lit up the dawn sky on the Thagla, No. 6 Platoon along with the rest of Bravo Company had ceased to exist.

Rikh's notes after the war said: '…the defensive battle fought by B Company at Log Bridge will also rank as one of the most gallant actions fought against the heaviest odds. The company lost over 80 per cent in killed alone, these included the company commander, two of the three platoon commanders and seven section commanders out of nine. This battle will be recalled with pride by all future generations of soldiers in the regiment, as an epic example of how the Rajputs fought and died…' The bulk of the Indian casualties were bullet injuries in the upper part of the body. The Chinese 7.62 mm low velocity ammunition was not as lethal as the Indian .303, but the ability to spray the target combined with the sheer volume of attacking troops meant the Indians were at a disadvantage. Apart from grenades, the attacking Chinese troops also used flame-throwers extensively, with which they would incinerate any surviving soldiers.

The Chinese referred to the Bridge 4 locality as Kalong. From their point of view, unlike the Temporary Bridge and Log Bridge positions that were isolated and could be approached and assaulted relatively easily from the rear, the Rajput Battalion HQ location at Bridge 4 had to be viewed in conjunction with Dhola, which was held by Alpha Company and elements of 5 Assam Rifles, while Wanbudiu (Tsangdhar) is where a company of 1/9 GR had its defences. Having studied the ground from their dominant positions on the Thagla, the Chinese would have known that the Battalion